



Beat That!

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CCNA INTRO

by TODD IAMMLE

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logged." ThePirateBay.org, however, looks fresh as ever.

People will doubtless continue to share music and movies, regardless of what happens to the P2P operators. There are simply too many people who will lend their servers to the "Darknet" for the whole thing to be wiped out.

But what's happening here is that it's not going to be for Joe Average any more—it's going to become more of a geek thing. Like it once was a geek thing to connect to another computer using a modem. This, if the Ass.es have their way—and they just might.

BEYOND ILLEGAL P2P

BitTorrent To Deliver Movies?

BitTorrent CEO Bram Cohen now seems all set to pitch P2P as the most efficient way of delivering HD content. It's

timed just right: cable companies are just about beginning to strain under increased costs of HD delivery, as more and more people get the idea that HD is the way video was meant to be. And with demand naturally poised to increase over the next couple of years, will P2P come to the rescue?

BitTorrent's pitch could have something to it, though there are detractors aplenty. The technology could need some work, but it does seem to hold promise. It's all about bandwidth efficiency—and one only needs to put out the mindset that one is "sharing" something while watching a movie downloaded via P2P, or that one is somehow doing something shady. Such misconceptions were once prevalent: Cohen, in an interview, said there were instances of "companies having a policy of not using any P2P technology at all, but some sysadmin would surreptitiously use BitTorrent for internal

distribution when it was warranted."

After BitTorrent's acquisition of μ Torrent, Cohen and μ Torrent creator Ludvig Strigeus said in a joint statement, "Bringing together μ Torrent's efficient implementation with BitTorrent's expertise in networking protocols will significantly benefit the community." And: "We will continue to develop μ Torrent, and will be using the code base in other applications, such as embedded systems on TVs, cell phones..." Meaning, effectively, that P2P is the way to go.

It's been a while since Cohen's company signed deals with major Hollywood studios including 20th Century Fox and MTV Networks. BitTorrent is forming distribution partnerships with film and TV studios including 20th Century Fox, MTV Networks, and Paramount Pictures. One of the goals, of course, is to be able to deliver—via P2P—content directly to users' set-top boxes. And,

"We're working on making BitTorrent come preinstalled on many embedded devices, as one of the basic services they support—in the same class as Web browsers," Cohen said in a recent interview.

Asked by Wired News about where he sees file-sharing going, Cohen had just this to say: "We're going to see everything... become more Web-based, and the special status of high-quality video files... as somehow different will go away. The current limitations on distributing them will cease to exist."

On the other side of the story, HDNet (an HDTV cable network in the US) chairman Mark Cuban, billionaire investor and dot-com veteran, has dismissed the notion of P2P as a content delivery platform as, well, nonsense: "I think P2P is great for corporate and controlled apps, but not for open distribution. P2P has content-distribution capabilities, but mass distribution of content isn't one of them."